

He slowly craned his neck around, and I was a little taken aback.

His body was frail and hunched over. His face was riddled with skin cancers. His hands felt like soft leather gloves.

Jack's voice was croaky and hard to make out, and the nurse, a no-nonsense type of woman, looked at me and yelled:

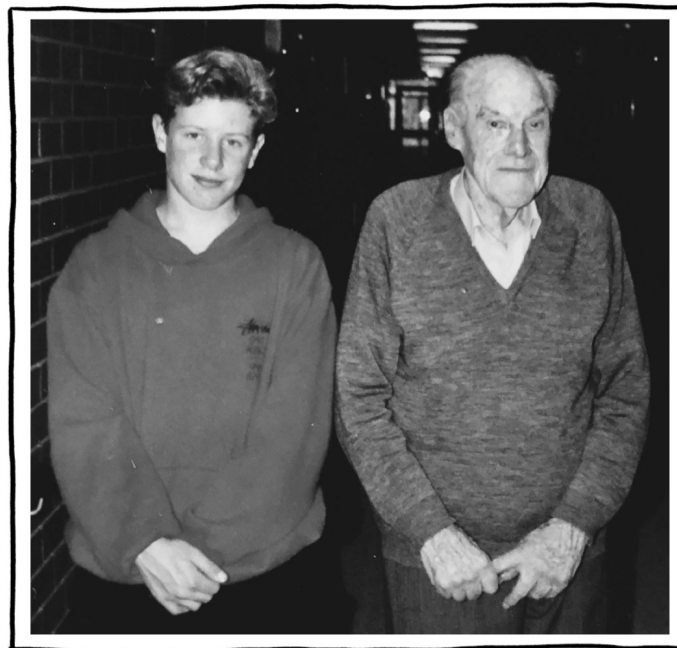
‘YOU WILL HAVE TO SPEAK LOUDLY TO JACK. HE’S HARD OF HEARING!’

‘OKAY!’ I yelled back, like it was she who was deaf.

As I awkwardly sat on the end of his bed, I had a sinking feeling in my stomach. I was hanging out in an old people’s home, with this little old man. What the hell had I got myself into?

But I needed my story, and that would take a little time.

So each Thursday I’d stop off on my way home to see Jack, and each Thursday I’d find him patiently waiting for me in his chair, ready to go.



Scott (13) and Jack (90)

And . . . I hated it.